

# HEALTH FIRST TASTE ALWAYS



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## HEALTH special 10 Wellness Meter

better services, products, ambience and comforts," says market analyst, Charu Sehgal, head of Life Sciences and Healthcare in Deloitte Touche Tohmatsu India Private Limited.

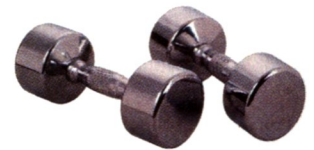
Driving the wellness boom, says the FICCI-Ernst & Young report, are corporate clients, many of whom are taking active steps to inculcate wellness as part of employee lifestyle. It wasn't always so. In the early '90s when Tata Steel started a corporate wellness initiative—mandatory annual medical check-ups, counselling employees on diet, exercise and stress management, daily work-outs at the workplace, age and gender-related sport—it hardly created a stir. But India Inc did sit up and take notice when the company profited out of the venture. A five-year study in 1995 showed that while employee health status had gone up the medical expenses of the group had come down by 33 per cent. Today the top spenders in wellness are ITES/BPO firms along with leisure and hospitality companies, spending about 11 per cent of non-compensation facilities on wellness—health food counters, nutritional counselling, psychologist on call, health camps and seminars, gymnasiums, spa and massage therapies to a crèche service.

Wellness is emerging as an ever-expanding pie that everybody wants a slice of. And they are all targeting the corporate workforce. Take hospitals, for instance. "The emergence of large hospitals providing a bouquet of services—from preventive check-ups to complex surgeries to wellness—is a significant trend," says Sehgal. Apollo Hospital, credited with pioneering India's corporate wellness movement, started it all in 1987 by launching preventive health check-ups. From a wellness wing in 1997 to India's first graduate course in wellness management to instituting corporate wellness awards along with the CII in 2008—the journey has been long. The new buzzword in Max Healthcare is wellness, too, with a bouquet that ranges from health-checks, weight management modules, stress audits, tobacco clinics, to health tips via SMS, microsites and helplines. Check out the brand new Kokila Dhirubhai Hospital in

### India Inc Offers a Healthy Deal



- ▶ Tips on diet and nutrition
- ▶ Health food and salad bars



- ▶ Space for gymming/yoga
- ▶ Health workshops & talks



- ▶ Executive health check-ups
- ▶ Psychologist on call



- ▶ Quit-smoking sessions
- ▶ Lifestyle assessments



- ▶ Recreation rooms
- ▶ Stress-busting sessions



- ▶ Tips on sleep disorders
- ▶ Crèche for employees' kids